جمعة في القدس القديمة

jum3a fil-quds il-qadiime

A Friday in the Old City



اللهجة الفلسطينية — القدس

Spoken Palestinian (Jerusalem). No fus7a, no tashkeel.

Before you start

Sami's first Friday at Al-Aqsa with Seedo — through the Old City alleys, the crowd at Damascus Gate, and a chance meeting with an old friend. This book adds "so that", how to report what someone said, and how to say something *won't* happen.

THE CHAT ALPHABET

7	ح	hard breathy H
5	خ	kh
3	ع	ayn
2	ء	glottal stop *only* — hamza
8	غ	French-style r
q	ق	written **q**, said as a glottal stop in Jerusalem

AROUND THE OLD CITY

البلدة القديمة	*il-balad il-qadiime*	the Old City
المسجد الأقصى	*il-masjid il-aqsa*	Al-Aqsa Mosque
باب العامود	*baab il-3amoud*	Damascus Gate
سوق	*souq*	market · pl. أسواق aswaaq

New grammar, in one line. عشان before a bare verb = "so that / in order to". حكى إنه = "said that he..." reports what someone said. ما رح before a verb = "won't". All three are in the notes at the back.



يوم جمعة الصبح، سيدو لبس تيابه الحلوة وقال لسامي:

«يا سيدي، اليوم بدي اخدك وياي عالمسجد الأقصى، أول مرة تصلي فيه معي. بس عشان نوصل بدري، لازم نطلع قبل الأذان بساعة.»

سامي فرح كتير وقال: «أكيد يا سيدو! بس ليش لازم نطلع هلق بالذات؟»

سيدو ضحك وقال: «عشان الشوارع بتزحم قبل الصلاة بشوي، وما بدي نتأخر.»

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yom jum3a is-sob7, Seedo libis tyaabo il-7ilwe w-2aal la-Saami:
“ya seedi, il-yom biddi a5udak wiyyaay 3al-masjid il-aqsa, awwal marra tsalli fii ma3i. bass 3ashaan nousal badri, laazim nitla3 qabel il-azaan bi-saa3a.”
Saami fira7 kteer w-2aal: “akiid ya Seedo! bass leesh laazim nitla3 hala2 bi-zaato?”
Seedo di7ik w-2aal: “3ashaan ish-shawaari3 btiz7am qabel is-salaa bi-shwayy, w-ma biddi nit2a55ar.”

On Friday morning, Grandpa put on his nice clothes and said to Sami: "My dear, today I want to take you with me to Al-Aqsa Mosque, the first time you'll pray there with me. But so that we arrive early, we have to leave an hour before the call to prayer." Sami was very happy and



مشيوا سوا بأزقة البلدة القديمة، بين دكاكين البهارات والقماش.

سيدو حكى لسامي إنه هالسوق قديم كتير، وإنه جده هو كمان كان يمشي بنفس الطريق.

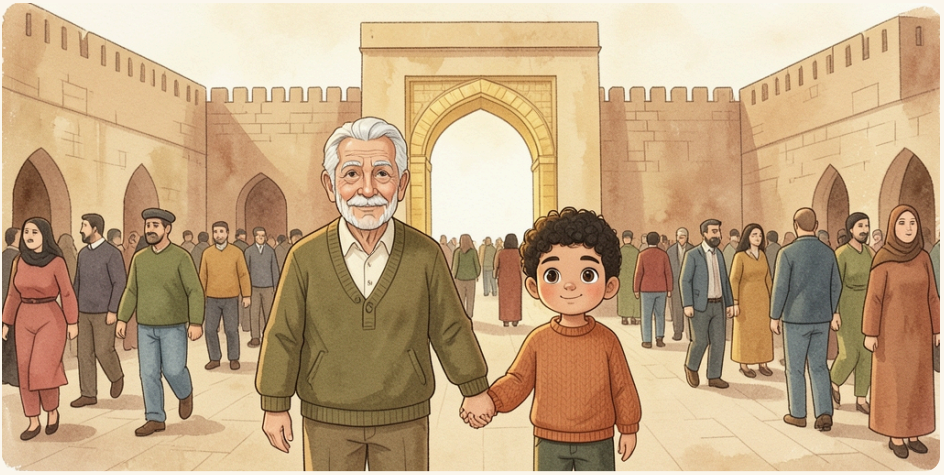
سامي شم ريحة القهوة والبهارات وقال: «سيدو، شو هالريحة الحلوة يلي بكل مكان؟»

سيدو قاله: «هاي ريحة القدس يا سيدي. ما رح تنساها طول عمرك.»

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mashu sawa bi-azqit il-balad il-qadiime, been dakaakiin il-bhaaraat wil-qmaash.
Seedo 7aka la-Saami inno has-souq qadiim kteer, w-inno jiddo huwwe kamaan kaan yimshi bi-nafs it-tariiq.
Saami shamm ree7et il-qahwe wil-bhaaraat w-2aal: "Seedo, shu hal-ree7a il-7ilwe yalli bikill makaan?"
Seedo 2allo: "hayy ree7et il-quds ya seedi. ma ra7 tinsaaha tuul 3umrak."

They walked together through the alleys of the Old City, between the spice shops and the fabric shops. Grandpa told Sami that this market is very old, and that his own grandfather used to walk the same path. Sami smelled the coffee and spices and said: "Grandpa, what's this lovely smell that's everywhere?" Grandpa said to him: "That's the smell of Jerusalem, my dear. You won't forget it your whole life."



قرب باب العامود، صار في زحمة كبيرة وناس كتير ماشية بكل الاتجاهات.

سيدو مسك ايد سامي وقال: «امسك ايدي منيح، عشان ما تضيع مني بهالزحمة.»

سامي مسك ايده بقوة وقال: «ما رح ارخيها ابدا، وعده!»

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qarrab min baab il-3amoud, saar fii za7me kbiire w-naas kteer maashye bikill il-ittijaahaat. Seedo misik eed Saami w-2aal: "imsik eedi mnee7, 3ashaan ma tdii3 minni bihaz-za7me." Saami misik eedo bi-qowwe w-2aal: "ma ra7 arkhiiha abadan, w3ad!"

Near Damascus Gate, a big crowd built up, with lots of people walking in every direction. Grandpa held Sami's hand and said: "Hold my hand tightly, so you don't get lost from me in this crowd." Sami gripped his hand hard and said: "I won't let go, ever, I promise!"



لما وصلوا لباحة المسجد، وقف سامي مبهور. الباحة كانت واسعة كتير، وقبة الصخرة الذهبية لامعة تحت الشمس.

سيدو قاله بصوت هادي: «هون، الكل بيصير أهدى. حتى الأولاد بيمشوا شوي شوي.»

سامي حس براحة غريبة، وقعد جنب سيدو بهدوء لحد ما بلشت الصلاة.

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lamma wislu la-baa7et il-masjid, wiqif Saami mabhour. il-baa7a kaanet waas3a kteer, w-qubbet is-sa5ra iz-zahabiyye laam3a ta7t ish-shams.
Seedo 2allo bi-sowt haadi: "hoon, il-kill bisiir ahda. 7atta il-wlaad bimshu shwayy shwayy."
Saami 7ass bi-raa7a ghariibe, w-23ad janb Seedo bi-hudou2 la7ad ma balashet is-salaa.

When they reached the courtyard of the mosque, Sami stood there amazed. The courtyard was very wide, and the Dome of the Rock's gold shone under the sun. Grandpa said to him quietly: "Here, everyone becomes calmer. Even the children walk more slowly." Sami felt a strange sense of peace, and sat beside Grandpa quietly until the prayer began.



بعد الصلاة، صادفوا رجل عجوز عارف سيدو من زمان.

الرجل عانق سيدو وقال لسامي: «يا سلام! هاد حفيدك؟ سيدك كان يلعب معي هون وأنا صغير، قبل ما تولد إنت بكتير!»

سيدو ضحك وقال: «إي والله، كنا نتسابق لحد سور البلدة ورجعة!»

سامي ضحك وسأل: «سيدو، مين كان يفوز أكتر؟»

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ba3d is-salaa, saadafu rajul 3ajouz 3aarif Seedo min zamaan.
ir-rajul 3aanaq Seedo w-2aal la-Saami: "ya salaam! haad 7afeedak? seedak kaan yil3ab ma3i hoon w-ana zgheer, qabel ma tuulad inte bi-kteer!"
Seedo di7ik w-2aal: "ii wallah, kunna nitsaabaq la7ad sour il-balad w-raj3a!"
Saami di7ik w-so2al: "Seedo, meen kaan yifouz aktar?"

After the prayer, they ran into an old man who had known Grandpa for years. The man embraced Grandpa and said to Sami: "Well I never! Is this your grandson? Your grandpa used to play with me here when I was little, long before you were born!" Grandpa laughed and said: "Yes indeed, we used to race to the city wall and back!" Sami laughed and asked: "Grandpa, who used to win more?"



وهم راجعين عالبيت، مروا عالسوق، وسامي شاف محل بياع فيه سبح خشب حلوة.

سأل البياع: «قديش هاي السبحة؟» البياع قال: «خمسين شيقل بس ليك.»

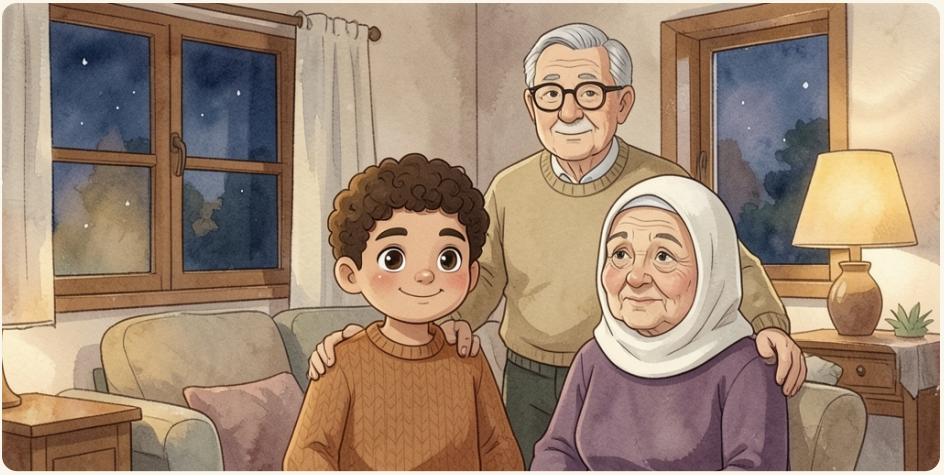
سامي فكر وقال لسيدو: «ما رح اشتريها إذا كانت غالية هيك، بدي دور على شي أرخص.»

سيدو ابتسم وقال: «هلق صرت تفهم قيمة المصاري. منيح يا سيدي.»

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w-humme raj3een 3al-beet, marru 3as-souq, w-Saami shaaf ma7all bayyaa3 fii sbe7 5ashab 7ilwe.
so2al il-bayyaa3: "qaddeesh hayy is-sib7a?" il-bayyaa3 2aal: "5amseen shiqel bass ilak."
Saami fakkar w-2aal la-Seedo: "ma ra7 ashtriiha iza kaanet 8aalye heek, biddi dawwir 3ala shi ar5as."
Seedo ibtasam w-2aal: "hala2 sirt tifham qeemet il-masaari. mnee7 ya seedi."

On their way back home, they passed through the market, and Sami saw a shop selling nice wooden prayer beads. He asked the seller: "How much is this?" The seller said: "Fifty shekels, just for you." Sami thought and said to Grandpa: "I won't buy it if it's this expensive, I want to look for something cheaper." Grandpa smiled and said: "Now you're starting to understand the value of money. Well done, my dear."



بالليل، سامي قعد يحكي لتيتا عن كل شي شافه: الأزقة، والمسجد، والرجل يلي كان صاحب سيدو زمان.

تيتا سمعت بابتسامة وقالت: «شفت؟ القدس مش بس مكان، هي حكاية كل عيلتنا.»

سيدو حط ايده على كتف سامي وقال: «وبكرة، رح تصير إنت يلي تحكي هاي الحكاية لولادك.»

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bil-leel, Saami 23ad ye7ki la-Teta 3an kill shi shaafo: il-azqe, wil-masjid, wir-rajul yalli kaan saa7ib Seedo zamaan.
Teta simi3et bi-btisaame w-2aalat: "shift? il-quds mish bass makaan, hiyye 7ikaayet kill 3eeltna."
Seedo 7att eedo 3ala ktef Saami w-2aal: "w-bukra, ra7 tseer inte yalli te7ki hayy il-7ikaaye la-wlaadak."

At night, Sami sat telling Grandma about everything he'd seen: the alleyways, the mosque, and the man who had been Grandpa's friend long ago. Grandma listened with a smile and said: "See? Jerusalem isn't just a place, it's the story of our whole family." Grandpa put his hand on Sami's shoulder and said: "And one day, you'll be the one telling this story to your kids."

Words from this story

Getting ready, and finding your way through the Old City.

تياب	*tyaab*	clothes
الأذان	*il-azaan*	the call to prayer
بالذات	*bi-zaato*	specifically, exactly (that one)
بتزحم	*btiz7am*	it gets crowded
أزقة	*azqe*	alleyways · sg. زقاق zqaaq
حكى ... إنه	*7aka ... inno*	told ... that (he/it) — reporting speech
شم	*shamm*	he smelled
طول عمرك	*tuul 3umrak*	your whole life
ضاع	*daa3*	he got lost · يضيع ydii3
وعد	*w3ad*	a promise · also "I promise!" on its own

Words from this story · continued

باحة	*baa7a*	a courtyard
مبهور	*mabhour*	amazed, dazzled
بهدوء	*bi-hudou2*	calmly · هادي haadi calm
صادف	*saadaf*	he ran into (someone) by chance
حفيد	*7afeed*	grandson
تسابق	*tsaabaq*	to race each other
فاز	*faaz*	he won · يفوز yfouz
قديش	*qaddeesh*	how much (asking a price)
أرخص	*ar5as*	cheaper · رخيص ar5iis cheap
قيمة	*qeeme*	value, worth

Dialect notes

"So that", reporting what someone said, and saying something won't happen.

1 · عشان + BARE VERB = "SO THAT / IN ORDER TO"

Like ممكن / لازم / بدّي, the verb after عشان drops its بـ:

امسك ايدي عشان ما تضيع. *imsik eedi 3ashaan ma tdii3.* Hold my hand so you don't get lost.

عشان can also just mean "because" — context tells you which:

عشان الشوارع بتزحم. *3ashaan ish-shawaari3 btiz7am.* Because the streets get crowded.

2 · REPORTING WHAT SOMEONE SAID

Put إنه (for "he/it") or إنها (for "she/it") straight after a verb of speaking, then the reported sentence follows normally:

حكى إنه تعبان	*7aka inno ta3baan*	he said that he's tired
قالت إنها جاهزة	*2aalat inneha jaahza*	she said that she's ready
حكى إنه السوق قديم	*7aka inno is-souq qadiim*	he said that the market is old

Dialect notes · continued

3 · ما رح = WON'T

Put ما before رح to negate the future — this is what you'll hear most; مش رح is also fine and means the same thing:

ما رح تنساها. *ma ra7 tinsaaha.* You won't forget it.

ما رح اشتريها إذا كانت غالية. *ma ra7 ashtriiha iza kaanet 8aalye.* I won't buy it if it's expensive.

4 · ASKING A PRICE

قديش هاي؟ *qaddeesh hayy?* How much is this? — the one phrase every market conversation starts with.

> **Where to go next.** This book leans on everything before it — ممكن / لازم from book 4, / إذا لو from book 5, and كان + present for "used to" from book 3. Re-read all six stories back to back if you want to feel how far you've come.

Now you try

Purpose clauses, reported speech, and the negative future — all from this book.

1 · FILL THE GAP WITH عشان

١) بدنا نطلع بدري ___ نوصل قبل الزحمة.

٢) امسك ايدي ___ ما تضيع.

2 · REPORT IT

سيدو قال: «أنا تعبان.» → سيدو قال ___ تعبان.

تيتا قالت: «الأكل جاهز.» → تيتا قالت ___ الأكل جاهز.

3 · TRANSLATE INTO DIALECT

١) I won't buy it if it's expensive.

٢) He told me that the market is old.

٣) Hold my hand so you don't get lost.

Answers. 1) 3 — إنه · إنها (2 — عشان · (عشان حكالي إنه · ما رح اشتريها إذا كانت غالية. امسك ايدي عشان ما تضيع. · السوق قديم.